

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, September 01, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ **Turkmenistan just plugged 8 of the world's worst methane leaks**

***The Angle:** This is the feel-good climate story nobody saw coming - a country notorious for some of the planet's worst gas leaks just quietly fixed eight of them, and the UN says it's already moving the needle on greenhouse gas emissions.*

- **Turkmenistan** has sealed **8 major methane leaks** after years of ranking among the **worst methane emitters on Earth**
- The **UN** confirms the repairs are **already delivering real, measurable emissions reductions**
- Methane is one of the **most damaging greenhouse gases** - far more potent than CO2 in the short term
- This marks a **major turnaround** for a country that's long been a top global source of leaks

The Silver Lining Moment

- Quick takeaway: sometimes the biggest climate wins come from the most unexpected places - not a splashy summit, just quietly fixing pipes.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.theguardian.com/environment/2026/aug/31/turkmenistan-methane-leaks-un-alerts-mars>

■ **CD Projekt Red offers to help after police reports are filed at Gamescom over stolen dev equipment: "We'll check the Arasaka hardware archives"**

***The Angle:** CD Projekt Red offers to help after police reports are filed at Gamescom over stolen dev equipment: "We'll check the Arasaka hardware archives"*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.gamesradar.com/games/cd-projekt-red-offers-to-help-after-police-reports-are-filed-at-gamescom-over-stolen-dev-equipment-well-check-the-arasaka-hardware-archives/>

■ **World's chubbiest parrot just had a baby boom**

***The Angle:** The kākāpō is one of the most endangered birds on Earth — flightless, nocturnal, and famously bad at reproducing — so a chick surge like this is a rare good-news story in conservation, and people love an underdog comeback.*

- **90 new chicks** have hatched, giving a major boost to the total wild population
- The kākāpō is the **world's heaviest parrot** — flightless and nocturnal, found only in **New Zealand**
- The species has spent decades on the brink of extinction, making any breeding season a big win for conservationists

The Feel-Good Break

- Sometimes the biggest story of the day is just a fat, flightless bird making a comeback — what's the last 'nature win' that actually made you smile?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.theguardian.com/world/2026/sep/01/record-breeding-worlds-heaviest-parrot-nz-endangered-kakapo>

■ **Amazon workers on food stamps triple as company drops \$200B on AI**

The Angle: It's the ultimate corporate-priorities gut-punch story — a trillion-dollar company pouring \$200 billion into AI while a growing share of its own warehouse and delivery workforce reportedly needs food stamps just to get by.

- The number of **Amazon workers relying on food stamps** has reportedly nearly **tripled**.
- At the same time, **Amazon** is pouring roughly **\$200 billion** into AI investment.
- The contrast is fueling fresh backlash over **wages vs. tech spending** at one of the world's biggest employers.

The Debate Starter

- Should a company be allowed to spend \$200 billion on AI while its own workers need government assistance to eat?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://finance.yahoo.com/economy/articles/amazon-workers-food-stamps-nearly-101524906.html?guccounter=1&guce_referrer=aHR0cHM6Ly9vbGQucmVhZG90LmNvbS8&guce_referrer_sig=AQAAALsu1suWbBdeVP5nhZin06RrrySoHjWWzxPDrWLFs4BPhr3i5gloYsxjq_a_oHM3PbzS70Yk-npgs3T1zZ1706GcaLAaHFkZv3nT3C4yhEpofWRnGulkyj29TMBhGqATLinGuT-IFRFwJAF_eXImgAaVXPBjDRUI4t_MFXA8Gn4G

■ **Florida just ripped surveillance cameras off its highways**

The Angle: Florida ordering Flock Safety's license-plate cameras off state highways plugs right into the national fight over surveillance tech and privacy — these cameras are used by police departments all over the country, so this isn't just a Florida story.

- **Florida** has ordered **Flock Safety** license-plate-reading cameras removed from stretches of state highway.
- **Flock** cameras are automated license-plate readers already deployed by thousands of police departments nationwide.
- The order taps into a bigger, coast-to-coast debate over surveillance tech, data privacy, and how much law enforcement should be tracking drivers by default.

The Debate Starter

- Are license-plate cameras keeping your highway safer, or is this just surveillance creep — where should that line be?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.businessinsider.com/florida-orders-removal-flock-camera-state-highways-license-plate-readers-2026-8>

Backup options:

■ **NASA launches new telescope that can scan the universe 1,000 times faster than Hubble**

The Angle: NASA launches new telescope that can scan the universe 1,000 times faster than Hubble

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://interestingengineering.com/space/nasa-launches-new-telescope-that-can-scan-the-universe-1000-times-faster-than-hubble>

■ **Politicians Loved Data Centers. Now They're Running Away From Them. (w/ Nathaniel Rich)**

The Angle: Politicians Loved Data Centers. Now They're Running Away From Them. (w/ Nathaniel Rich)

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.thebulwark.com/p/politicians-loved-data-centers-now>

■ **Nuclear fusion: new US-China race for limitless power**

The Angle: Nuclear fusion: new US-China race for limitless power

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.newsweek.com/nuclear-fusion-new-us-china-race-limitless-power-12330062>

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ ■ Doug Ford sits down for a one-on-one grilling

The Angle: Ontario's premier going head-to-head with CTV's Question Period is always good for a headline or two - Ford's never shy with a quote, and whatever he says here could ripple into US-Canada trade and politics chatter too.

The Debate Starter

- Love him or hate him, Doug Ford always gives you a soundbite - what do you want him held to account for right now?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi_wFBVV95cUxOczFNazlsYjg1MnRKSU1ZNkVWDE5ME5nTGvKbmM3ZXhQcERVt2VOY3hvOHNGNGVUTDd2WxVlQV9KX2dYUUIWUS1MbXp3dUdCdkJES0t4UWkweW5sb3pMR3RFT3AwdTUza2JGTHFsTURrcW56RVV0Y3VLMHktNHJPd1ZhSFZHeVNjTDJ1dXdOWTk0eXRBQXM1MGh4N1MwYlI0b1F4OHpxcDFRRXRwWHJjUjA5eHN3S3FyT3RscEE3VHRKLWpjUWk4WG9GYTFVRU1ZMlk1WGCySGUyLUNmcnZxdGFBZWVWVl96YzZM1OHZHa19SUXRycDISejhpeXdidEk?oc=5

■ ■ MapQuest Kept 'Lake Ontario' — Canada Made It No. 1

The Angle: Amid all the border-renaming drama swirling around US map apps lately, MapQuest just refused to touch Lake Ontario's name — and Canadians rewarded it by shooting it to the top of the download charts. It's a tiny app-store stat turning into a full-blown loyalty statement.

- MapQuest jumped to the **No. 1 spot** in the Navigation category on app charts.
- The surge followed MapQuest's refusal to rename **Lake Ontario**.
- The remnant of a 2000s nostalgia brand is suddenly winning a modern nationalism moment.

The National Pride Play

- Would you actually switch apps over a lake keeping its name, or is this just marketing dressed up as patriotism?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/31/mapquests-app-surges-to-no-1-in-navigation-after-refusing-to-rename-lake-ontario/?utm_medium=organic_social&utm_source=TWITTER

■ US Congressman: Alberta Could Join America If It Splits From Canada

The Angle: Alberta separatist talk has been simmering for a while, and now a US lawmaker is throwing gasoline on it by suggesting the province could become the 51st state - guaranteed to rile up Canadian listeners on both sides of the independence debate.

- **Andy Harris** raised the idea of **Alberta** becoming the **51st state** if the province were to secede from **Canada**.
- The comment plugs into ongoing **Alberta separatism** chatter that's been building north of the border.
- It echoes the bigger, controversial pattern of US figures floating **Canada** or its provinces joining the **United States**.

The Debate Starter

- Would Alberta actually be better off as a US state - or is this just American politicians trolling Canada again?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.mediaite.com/media/tv/house-republican-floats-making-alberta-51st-state-if-it-secedes-tremendous-oil-reserves-there/>

Backup options:

■ **Canada is ready for its economic Independence Day Whether it is building new LNG terminals to serve global energy needs, or a trillion-dollar cross-country electricity grid to power the future, an exciting thing is unfolding. A maturing Canada is standing tall on its own feet.**

The Angle: Canada is ready for its economic Independence Day Whether it is building new LNG terminals to serve global energy needs, or a trillion-dollar cross-country electricity grid to power the future, an exciting thing is unfolding. A maturing Canada is standing tall on its own feet.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.hilltimes.com/2026/08/31/canada-is-ready-for-its-economic-independence-day/516153/>

■ **BYD Asked About Taking Over Canada Stellantis Plant, Mayor Says**

The Angle: BYD Asked About Taking Over Canada Stellantis Plant, Mayor Says

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-08-31/byd-asks-about-buying-stellantis-stla-brampton-plant-for-buses-mayor>

■ **To shelve or not to shelve: How the American alcohol response varies widely by province**

The Angle: To shelve or not to shelve: How the American alcohol response varies widely by province

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/nova-scotia/american-alcohol-boycott-ban-canada-provinces-how-it-works-9.7325515?cmp=rss>

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ **Rick Springfield, 77, Breaks the Internet with His Body**

The Angle: The 'Jessie's Girl' guy just reminded everyone he's pushing 80 and still shredded — it's the kind of shirtless-grandpa-goals moment that makes for an easy, fun water-cooler tangent about aging gracefully.

- **Rick Springfield** — the voice behind the 1981 classic "Jessie's Girl" — is going viral for his physique.
- He's **77 years old**, and that's exactly why the photos are stopping people mid-scroll.
- People.com flagged it as a "jaw-dropping" moment online.

The Debate Starter

- Who's your pick for best-aging rockstar — Rick Springfield or someone else on your list?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMijgFBVV95cUxOc2xqSjZOMHBfTVFfemFJbEVKU1NKSnltS0o1X1hmby1VUmFKcWc5bVNFY0FxBRTNTOEZsQ2JoNUJua0djVkdYkN6d3YtbE1TdzdKeFRrQUxFam9FQk95Yk81X3B2SEITLWc5bGZfWkpIMDgzTjZkdThpc1pkX0VMd3RXLVRqRVhsR1lqb3R3?oc=5>

■ **Your algorithm might be boring you to death**

The Angle: Everyone's noticed their Spotify and Netflix recommendations feel stuck on repeat lately - turns out that's by design, and new research says it's actually backfiring on how much we enjoy the stuff we watch and listen to.

- **Spotify** and **Netflix** algorithms track what you engage with most and keep feeding you more of the same
- Genres or shows you don't click on enough quietly get **dropped** from what gets recommended to you
- Researchers are calling the resulting rut '**overfamiliarity**' - the same lane, over and over
- The tradeoff: more of what you already like now, but **less satisfaction** with your entertainment over time

The Phone-In Trigger

- Be honest - when's the last time your streaming app actually surprised you?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Open the App** - 30 seconds, live on air -> Both hosts pull up their Spotify or Netflix home screen and describe out loud what's being recommended to them right now.

- **Step 2: Rate the Rut** - 1 minute -> Hosts call out whether their recs feel fresh or like the same five things on repeat - then invite callers/texters to send in their own 'stuck in a loop' recommendation screenshots.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.rotman.utoronto.ca/news-events-and-ideas/news-and-stories/2026/july-2026/engagement-driven-curation-overfamiliarity-cultural-consumption-study/>

■ **D4vd's Lawyers Bail — Public Defender Steps In**

The Angle: A switch from private counsel to a public defender is a loaded signal in any celebrity legal saga, and it's the kind of detail that gets fans and industry-watchers speculating about what's really going on behind the scenes.

- D4vd's legal team has formally **withdrawn** from his case.
- He's now being represented by a **public defender** instead of private counsel.

The Speculation Starter

- Lawyers walking away and a public defender stepping in — is this about money, strategy, or something bigger brewing in the case?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.tmz.com/2026/08/31/d4vd-lawyers-withdraw-now-repped-by-public-defender/>

■ **Beartooth singer Caleb Shomo says he faced 'a lot of homophobia' after coming out gay, divorcing wife of 14 years**

The Angle: Beartooth singer Caleb Shomo says he faced 'a lot of homophobia' after coming out gay, divorcing wife of 14 years

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/30/celebrity-news/beartooth-singer-caleb-shomo-says-he-faced-a-lot-of-homophobia-after-coming-out-gay-divorcing-wife-of-14-years/>

Backup options:

■ **Gal Gadot Defends Starring in Movie With AI Sets and Lighting Because 'You're Going to Work With It or Be Out of the Game'; Lawyers Spent 6 Months Ensuring AI Would Not Alter Actors**

The Angle: Gal Gadot Defends Starring in Movie With AI Sets and Lighting Because 'You're Going to Work With It or Be Out of the Game'; Lawyers Spent 6 Months Ensuring AI Would Not Alter Actors

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/film/news/gal-gadot-defends-bitcoin-movie-ai-sets-lighting-1236847413/>

■ **Kelly Clarkson sings the show's most requested song, Kpop Demon Hunters' "Golden," for her very last Kellyoke**

The Angle: Kelly Clarkson sings the show's most requested song, Kpop Demon Hunters' "Golden," for her very last Kellyoke

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://v.redd.it/jxf38f5khrmh1>

■ **A young boy was invited on stage at an Idles concert in Belfast. And in front of thousands, the child called for the liberation of Palestine.**

The Angle: A young boy was invited on stage at an Idles concert in Belfast. And in front of thousands, the child called for the liberation of Palestine.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://v.redd.it/r38zzktrmh1>

■ **Chappell Roan and her band at Daisy Chain Fields**■

The Angle: Chappell Roan and her band at Daisy Chain Fields■

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://i.redd.it/aq8o0aco0rmh1.jpeg>

TRENDING TODAY

■ **Kansas City bride goes viral after being summoned for jury duty on same day as wedding in Italy**

The Angle: Kansas City bride goes viral after being summoned for jury duty on same day as wedding in Italy

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL:

<https://nypost.com/2026/09/01/us-news/kansas-city-bride-katrina-badowski-summoned-for-jury-duty-on-same-day-as-wedding-in-italy/>

Backup options:

■ **Viral Golden Retriever Tucker Diagnosed with Cancer, Owner Shares - People.com**

The Angle: Viral Golden Retriever Tucker Diagnosed with Cancer, Owner Shares - People.com

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMilwFBVV95cUxOQjdlVjBFsk8wRW9PdIpU9zVWNqR2U4dWJfR09BWlVWQVZaNzRNdWNJZnVVTfcwZV9jUy1UdzdhRWxvTVZBeUdzNIUtaWxEWkFEYXk1bUk4dFA0QUI1NzVzZjktYW1pMEk1c3IGc21uNmVHVmNVcGhEMXRfWVHVqcEtiNUY5dHRwcUxOcVBIWnlzeVI0Z1FJ?oc=5>

■ **Kansas City bride goes viral after being summoned for jury duty on same day as wedding in Italy** <https://t.co/0V9D5EqluJ> <https://t.co/2F5jTbg>

The Angle: Kansas City bride goes viral after being summoned for jury duty on same day as wedding in Italy
<https://t.co/0V9D5EqluJ> <https://t.co/2F5jTbg>

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/nypost/status/2094706310105199064>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ **I Expected Tech Fatalism. Americans Are Putting Up a Remarkable Fight Instead.**

The Angle: I Expected Tech Fatalism. Americans Are Putting Up a Remarkable Fight Instead.

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.nytimes.com/2026/08/31/opinion/data-centers-ai-populism.html>

Backup options:

■ **People who eat more nuts tend to score higher on tests of thinking and memory, especially if they have generally poor diets or exercise habits. Among individuals who have experienced a stroke, eating nuts is linked to higher levels of a protein that helps grow new blood vessels.**

The Angle: People who eat more nuts tend to score higher on tests of thinking and memory, especially if they have generally poor diets or exercise habits. Among individuals who have experienced a stroke, eating nuts is linked to higher levels of a protein that helps grow new blood vessels.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.psypost.org/nut-consumption-is-associated-with-sharper-thinking-skills-and-post-stroke-brain-health-markers/>

■ **For Republicans, watching or reading more liberal news was linked to lower meta-prejudice and meta-dehumanization. For Democrats, higher exposure to conservative news was associated with lower meta-prejudice. When Republicans consumed more conservative news, they report higher meta-dehumanization.**

The Angle: For Republicans, watching or reading more liberal news was linked to lower meta-prejudice and meta-dehumanization. For Democrats, higher exposure to conservative news was associated with lower meta-prejudice. When Republicans consumed more conservative news, they report higher meta-dehumanization.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.psypost.org/researchers-identify-a-simple-way-to-soften-deep-political-divides/>

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ **Costa Rica just unanimously voted to require wildlife crossings on new and existing roads where they threaten animals or cut off habitat, protecting wildlife from traffic and reconnecting ecosystems. At least 59 species have already been documented using the country's wildlife bridges.**

The Angle: Costa Rica just unanimously voted to require wildlife crossings on new and existing roads where they threaten animals or cut off habitat, protecting wildlife from traffic and reconnecting ecosystems. At least 59 species have already been documented using the country's wildlife bridges.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.mongabay.com/short-article/2026/08/costa-rica-to-require-wildlife-crossings-for-roads-when-they-impact-fauna/>

Backup options:

■ **Andrew Garfield wanted Michael B Jordan as Peter Parker's male love interest in a wild Spider Man idea**

The Angle: Andrew Garfield wanted Michael B Jordan as Peter Parker's male love interest in a wild Spider Man idea

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://tribune.com.pk/story/2626052/andrew-garfield-wanted-michael-b-jordan-as-peter-parkers-love-interest>

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 0/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 2/3 this month)

■ **Jennifer Aniston's Boyfriend Jim Curtis Opens Up About Their Relationship in New Interview - People.com**

The Angle: Jennifer Aniston's Boyfriend Jim Curtis Opens Up About Their Relationship in New Interview - People.com

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 58/90 (25 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> STRONG

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMioAFBVV95cUxQbGRwZGp4aFBWRXdFZlY0VDJQTfIWQm4xVF9hcHNLeEJkZVlyYUxEMU9SZWlIQ2JCdmlrWFZucFNDYU40WnlzMW1EVTh3ckdwMWgwZkl4dGRlM2FzLThWekx4OGs2VE1kRIBIMl9NaG9jNUp2Zl02aUpKOWRBMXdpUFJGVE83aVRIQTE4eW1GLXpHU3JLRW41Uk11b3RpUkpy?oc=5>

■ **Brian Austin Green makes candid confession about his sex drive: ‘There’s no way to avoid that’**

The Angle: Brian Austin Green makes candid confession about his sex drive: ‘There’s no way to avoid that’

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 54/90 (25 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/31/celebrity-news/brian-austin-green-makes-candid-confession-about-his-sex-drive/>

Backup options:

■ **Billie Eilish Officiates Brother Finneas’ California Wedding to Claudia Sulewski — See the Photos - People.com**

The Angle: Billie Eilish Officiates Brother Finneas’ California Wedding to Claudia Sulewski — See the Photos - People.com

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 54/90 (25 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMipgFBVV95cUxPTEhwQWJaazZjbjFtMGFnTGhaejNEWdG3Uk9DTm5oai02U2l3enA0N0s5NG5wYmVOMVNSN09lOGV6VU0T2p4N2RNSTNuak5WTU1leUlld04zdWtDMUtrbWpFRkdhaV9NGGtyWnlKVDR0eS02LWR0dlIWbGtfVktHqWWhb0c2emJ0Rk1Fekk5SUI4TVRaQUFIZFZEYw5sRXRSSTBHUUURn?oc=5>

■ **Jennifer Aniston’s boyfriend Jim Curtis reveals how the couple resolves fights in the ‘honeymoon phase’ stage**

The Angle: Jennifer Aniston’s boyfriend Jim Curtis reveals how the couple resolves fights in the ‘honeymoon phase’ stage

Entertainment Weekly (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 49/90 (25 fit + 8 source + 16 quality) -> BACKUP

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimgFBVV95cUxPYUVxSHNxSWtvR3pPMm5wcnFmQjYtRkpUSFo4QTg3NlVWRkdzdGkzZGdfb083UVpsNV9qeJyQ2ZydGNYSg1BdXl0SVJOZW15d1hSbG53ZDY0dGQwb3M5d3pmMjFNVVWhPcWMwQUhkWG9oVU5wQmRUNDdhUHdWQ2NvN3JDSENlWm9hbm52R20yUWxsemdu2JpQjNB?oc=5>

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ **‘Superhuman’ AI tool spots heart disease in less than 2 seconds**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Pairs the universal fear of heart disease with an eye-catching ‘superhuman’ AI framing, which is a proven high-share combo for health+AI stories.

The Angle: ‘Superhuman’ AI tool spots heart disease in less than 2 seconds

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2026/aug/31/superhuman-ai-tool-spots-heart-disease>

■ **FTC sues Amazon, accusing the e-commerce giant of "secretly and systematically overcharged" misleading advertisers on its platform by manipulating its pricing and auction systems.**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): FTC vs. Amazon over advertiser price manipulation has a big recognizable defendant and taps the ongoing tech-antitrust news cycle, giving it pickup potential beyond the original subreddit.

The Angle: *FTC sues Amazon, accusing the e-commerce giant of "secretly and systematically overcharged" misleading advertisers on its platform by manipulating its pricing and auction systems.*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cnn.com/2026/08/31/amazon-ftc-lawsuit-advertisers.html>

■ **Jensen Huang and Lisa Su snubbed by TIME's 2026 list of top 100 AI leaders — Paris Hilton and Ben Affleck, among others, make the list as 'Architects of AI' inexplicably not listed**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The 'Jensen Huang and Lisa Su snubbed while Paris Hilton and Ben Affleck make an AI leaders list' contrast is inherently outrage/comedy bait that tends to spread fast on social feeds.

The Angle: *Jensen Huang and Lisa Su snubbed by TIME's 2026 list of top 100 AI leaders — Paris Hilton and Ben Affleck, among others, make the list as 'Architects of AI' inexplicably not listed*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/artificial-intelligence/jensen-huang-and-lisa-su-snubbed-by-times-2026-ai-list-paris-hilton-and-ben-affleck-among-others-make-the-list-as-architects-of-ai-are-totally-absent>

■ **Ex-gang leader found guilty of murder in Tupac Shakur's 1996 drive-by killing**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A guilty verdict in Tupac Shakur's 30-year-unsolved murder is a rare, decades-anticipated true-crime resolution with massive built-in name recognition.

The Angle: *Ex-gang leader found guilty of murder in Tupac Shakur's 1996 drive-by killing*

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: <https://www.nbcnews.com/news/us-news/verdict-trial-tupac-shakurs-killing-former-gang-leader-found-guilty-rcna594859>

■ **Woman randomly stabs 2 people in New York City's Times Square, killing 1, then is killed by police <https://t.co/pmOkZPeRFS>**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A random fatal stabbing in Times Square followed by a police shooting is a shocking, high-profile breaking crime story that typically accelerates fast once details and video circulate.

The Angle: *Woman randomly stabs 2 people in New York City's Times Square, killing 1, then is killed by police <https://t.co/pmOkZPeRFS>*

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 52/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 5 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: <https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2094583670900232196>

■ **The first US law targeting VPN use takes effect September 3: here's what happens <https://t.co/UQ5bPNjgg7> #deals**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The first US VPN law takes effect just two days from today, giving it urgent, direct relevance to the huge population of VPN users right as it becomes real.

The Angle: *The first US law targeting VPN use takes effect September 3: here's what happens <https://t.co/UQ5bPNjgg7> #deals*

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2094552336517468519>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)

- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground <https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt> <https://t.co/HwXL2>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)
- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors <https://t.c>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 13 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
 - "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal's Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
 - "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
 - "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
 - "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
 - "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to 'The Fast and the Furious' 25th Anniversary Screening in LA <https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg>" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)
 - "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt 'Disappointed' by BLACKPINK's 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
 - "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
 - "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
 - "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
 - "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary 'B'Day' Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
 - "'A modern Dickie Dee bike': Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia <https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1>" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
 - "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary <https://t.co/HWOFFtKZb>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
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SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)

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